

Medical Emoji proposals for Microsoft review

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Purpose

I plan to submit **CT Scan** and **Blood Bag** through Unicode's 2026 emoji intake after updating their evidence and image-rights language. **Pill Box** is the first alternate. Unicode's published filing window closes July 31. That places this work late in the cycle, but still before the deadline.

This brief asks Microsoft for two kinds of help:

1. Review the proposal shortlist, artwork, evidence, and rights record.
2. Advise on the appropriate Unicode route for the individual proposals and for a separate discussion document about health-related emoji coverage.

Current filing plan

CT Scan. This is the strongest developed proposal. It includes exhibits in all five evidence categories and has a clearer independent use case than the existing X-Ray emoji. Before filing, I will recapture its 2020 Search, Video, and Trends evidence using the current method, test the 18-pixel image against MRI and generic scanners, and state the artwork ownership clearly.

Blood Bag. This proposal also includes the five required evidence exhibits. It supports donation, transfusion, blood-supply, and patient-care communication that a Drop of Blood cannot fully express. I will refresh the 2020 evidence and test the image beside IV Bag because the two silhouettes are similar in black and white.

Pill Box, as the first alternate. Pill Box has an exhibit in each evidence category and communicates weekly medication organization more clearly than Pill Pack. Its historical usage evidence is weak and must be refreshed. Reviewers may also conclude that the existing Pill emoji is sufficient. Even with those limitations, Pill Box is the strongest medication option in the current portfolio.

Before submitting, I will complete the evidence updates, current factor labels, artwork-ownership records, document meta-data, and small-size recognition checks.

Questions for Microsoft

1. Review and working-group timing

After I submit the selected proposal PDFs through Unicode's official Emoji Submission Form, would Microsoft's Unicode standards representatives be willing to ask the Emoji Standard & Research Working Group to consider adding them to an upcoming agenda as part of its normal review process?

Unicode will control the agenda, review, and outcome. I am asking for Microsoft's technical review and help bringing these proposals to the working group's attention.

2. Separate UTC discussion document

The attached **Health-related emoji coverage** paper is now written as a final UTC submission document and names David Rhew, Heena Purohit, and Shuhan He as authors. Would David and Heena confirm the text and their public authorship? If they do, could Microsoft's standards team ask the current UTC delegate to route or introduce the paper through the normal member process?

The paper raises a broader standards and discoverability question: whether closely related medical concepts would benefit from clearer guidance on substitutes, visual distinction, and expected usage. It asks the UTC to refer the question to ESR for review and recommendation. It does not request the encoding of a group of emoji. Each candidate would still require its own submission through the official form.

Unicode assigns the official L2 number after accepting a technical document into its public register. The final PDF should therefore be submitted without an L2/26-~~xxx~~ placeholder. The document may support UTC discussion or referral to a working group; it does not replace an individual emoji proposal or guarantee a decision.

Portfolio at a glance

Position today	Concepts	Reason
Planned filings after revision	CT Scan; Blood Bag	All five evidence categories are present; both still need current-method evidence, rights, and design review
First alternate	Pill Box	Complete evidence categories; clearer weekly medication use than Pill Pack, but weak usage and overlap with Pill remain
Promising if evidence is completed	Ultrasound; Weight Scale	Broad uses and promising signals; required Trends or other Google evidence is missing
Other current-cycle drafts	White Blood Cell; Inhaler; IV Bag; Leg Cast; Pill Pack; Maze; First Aid Kit	Each has an evidence gap, a recognition problem, prior declines, or overlap with an existing emoji or another proposal
Later-cycle candidates	Kidney; Stomach; Liver	Their recorded November 4, 2022 decline notices fall within Unicode's four-year bar at the July 31, 2026 deadline

Why Pill Pack is not in the filing plan

Pill Pack is available as a draft, but it is not equivalent to Pill Box in readiness. It is missing Web Trends evidence, its Image Trends comparison uses the wrong comparator, and its 18-pixel image can resemble a keypad or remote. The name also risks confusion with the PillPack pharmacy brand. If the concept is revisited, **Blister Pack** may be the clearer generic name.

Filing both Pill Box and Pill Pack in the same intake would create an avoidable overlap question. The same applies to Blood Bag and IV Bag. The packet includes both pairs so Microsoft can compare them directly.

Relevant history

In 2018, Apple submitted L2/18-080, a proposal for nine accessibility emoji organized around four areas of accessibility. Apple described the set as a finite starting point, worked with disability organizations, and addressed Unicode's concern about open-ended categories. It is a useful example of a vendor explaining how related concepts fit together. Apple used the emoji-proposal process available in 2018; under the 2026 process, each encoding proposal must use the official form.

In 2019, Christian Kamkoff, Shuhan He, and Melissa Thermidor submitted separate proposals for Anatomical Heart and Lungs. Unicode later encoded both characters. The 2026 candidates must still succeed on their own evidence, distinctiveness, rights, and expected usage.

The current 2026 process separates the two routes clearly: individual emoji proposals go through the Emoji Submission Form, while a broader technical discussion document follows Unicode's document-submission process.

Public sources

Unicode emoji proposal guidance and 2026 filing window: <https://www.unicode.org/emoji/proposals.html>

Unicode document-submission process: <https://www.unicode.org/pending/docsubmit.html>

Apple accessibility proposal, L2/18-080: <https://www.unicode.org/L2/L2018/18080-accessibility-emoji.pdf>

Anatomical Heart proposal, L2/19-150: <https://www.unicode.org/L2/L2019/19150-heart-emoji.pdf>

Lungs proposal, L2/19-149: <https://www.unicode.org/L2/L2019/19149-lung-emoji.pdf>

Working proposal PDFs for CT Scan, Blood Bag, and Pill Box: <https://github.com/ShuhanCS/medicalemoji/tree/codex/eligible-2026-slate/submissions/v1.3.0>